KidsHealth in the Classroom

KidsHealth.org/classroom

Teacher's Guide

This guide includes:

- Standards
- Related Links
- Discussion Questions
- Activities for Students
- Reproducible Materials

Standards

This guide correlates with the following National Health Education Standards:

Students will:

- Comprehend concepts related to health promotion and disease prevention to enhance health.
- Demonstrate the ability to access valid information and products and services to enhance health.
- Demonstrate the ability to use interpersonal communication skills to enhance health and avoid or reduce health risks.
- Demonstrate the ability to practice health-enhancing behaviors and avoid or reduce health risks.

Your state's school health policies: nasbe.org/HealthySchools/States/State_Policy.asp



Grades 3 to 5 • Human Body Series

Respiratory System

Take a deep breath, feel your chest get slightly bigger, and exhale. You've just experienced your body's respiratory system in action! The following discussion questions and activities will help your students understand the parts of the respiratory system and their functions.

Related KidsHealth Links

Articles for Kids:

Looking at Your Lungs
KidsHealth.org/kid/body/lungs_noSW.html

Respiratory System (Movie)
KidsHealth.org/kid/how_the_body_works.html

Smoking Stinks!
KidsHealth.org/kid/stay_healthy/body/smoking.html

Asthma
KidsHealth.org/kid/asthma_basics/what/asthma.html

Pneumonia
KidsHealth.org/kid/ill_injure/sick/pneumonia.html

Discussion Questions

Note: The following questions are written in language appropriate for sharing with your students.

1. What is breathing? Why is it important for your body?
2. What are the body parts that help you breathe? Describe the role each part plays in helping your respiratory system do its job.
3. What can affect how well the respiratory system works? What can you do to keep your respiratory system healthy?

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Respiratory System

Activities for Students

Note: The following activities are written in language appropriate for sharing with your students.

Respiratory Relay Toss

Objectives:

Students will:

- Identify and explain the different body parts that make up the respiratory system
- Demonstrate knowledge of the respiratory paths that oxygen and carbon dioxide take during inhalation and exhalation

Materials:

- Computer with Internet access
- Beanbag or rubber ball
- Respiratory Relay Cards handout (available at: *KidsHealth.org/classroom/3to5/body/systems/respiratory_handout1.pdf*)

Class Time:

20 minutes

Activity:

In a group of 5, sit in a circle on the floor or at a table. Shuffle the Respiratory Relay Cards, and deal one to each person in your group. Going around the circle, have each person read the card and describe where that body part fits into the respiratory system. (Check out KidsHealth for information on how the respiratory system and your lungs work. You can make notes on the back of the card.) Then toss the beanbag or ball from person to person to match the order that oxygen would travel inside your body after you take a deep breath (starting with the trachea, or windpipe). As each person gets the beanbag, he or she needs to say the body part on his or her card and the body part that comes next. Do this a couple of times, then reshuffle, deal, and practice again. What happens to the order of the toss if you are exhaling? After you've practiced, the teacher will monitor the lights: lights on means inhaling, lights off means exhaling. Can your group keep your beanbag or ball in the air, in the right order, for one minute? How many "breaths," inhaling and exhaling, does your group take in one minute?

Extension:

1. Create riddles for each part of the respiratory system. Challenge a friend to figure out the riddle. (For example: I protect the lungs. I'm made up of 12 sets. I'm connected to your spine. What am I? Answer: Your rib cage!)

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Respiratory System

Take a Breath! Board Game

Objective:

Students will:

- Explain and describe the respiratory system, including all the body parts associated with inhaling and exhaling

Materials:

- Computer with Internet access
- Pencils
- Take a Breath! Game Board handout (available at: *KidsHealth.org/classroom/3to5/body/systems/respiratory_handout2.pdf*)
- Take a Breath! Breath Cards handout (available at: *KidsHealth.org/classroom/3to5/body/systems/respiratory_handout3.pdf*)
- A 6-faced die

Class Time:

1 hour

Activity:

It's time to play Take a Breath! But first, your group of 2 to 4 has to get the game ready by creating a set of Breath Cards. Check out the articles on KidsHealth to learn about the parts of the respiratory system that help you inhale and exhale, including your lungs, trachea, bronchi, bronchioles, alveoli, capillaries, diaphragm, and rib cage. Create a set of Breath Cards with a question about the respiratory system (there should be 20 questions per game) on the front of each card. Be sure to include the answers on the back! (For example: What keeps mucus and dirt out of your lungs? Answer: Cilia.) When all the Breath Cards are ready, place them (answer-side down!) next to the game board and play Take a Breath!

Extension:

1. What is pneumonia? Discuss what happens in your respiratory system if you have pneumonia.

Reproducible Materials

Handout: Respiratory Relay Cards
KidsHealth.org/classroom/3to5/body/systems/respiratory_handout1.pdf

Handout: Take a Breath! Game Board
KidsHealth.org/classroom/3to5/body/systems/respiratory_handout2.pdf

Handout: Take a Breath! Breath Cards
KidsHealth.org/classroom/3to5/body/systems/respiratory_handout3.pdf

KidsHealth

KidsHealth.org is devoted to providing the latest children's health information. The site, which is widely recommended by educators, libraries, and school associations, has received the "Teachers' Choice Award for the Family" and the prestigious Pirelli Award for "Best Educational Media for Students." KidsHealth comes from the nonprofit Nemours Foundation. Check out www.KidsHealth.org to see the latest additions!

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KidsHealth in the Classroom

Human Body Series

Respiratory System

Instructions: Photocopy this page so that you'll have a copy for each group of 5 students. Then, cut out the cards for each group.

RESPIRATORY RELAY

Trachea



RESPIRATORY RELAY

Bronchioles



RESPIRATORY RELAY

Main Stem Bronchi



RESPIRATORY RELAY

Alveolus



RESPIRATORY RELAY

Capillary



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KidsHealth in the Classroom



Human Body Series

Respiratory System

Take a Breath! Cards

Instructions: Photocopy this page so that you'll have 20 cards. Cut out the cards, and write a question about the respiratory system on the front of each. On the back, write the answer. Once you have all 20 cards filled out, you're ready to play Take a Breath!

Take a Breath!	Take a Breath!	Take a Breath!	Take a Breath!	Take a Breath!
Take a Breath!	Take a Breath!	Take a Breath!	Take a Breath!	Take a Breath!

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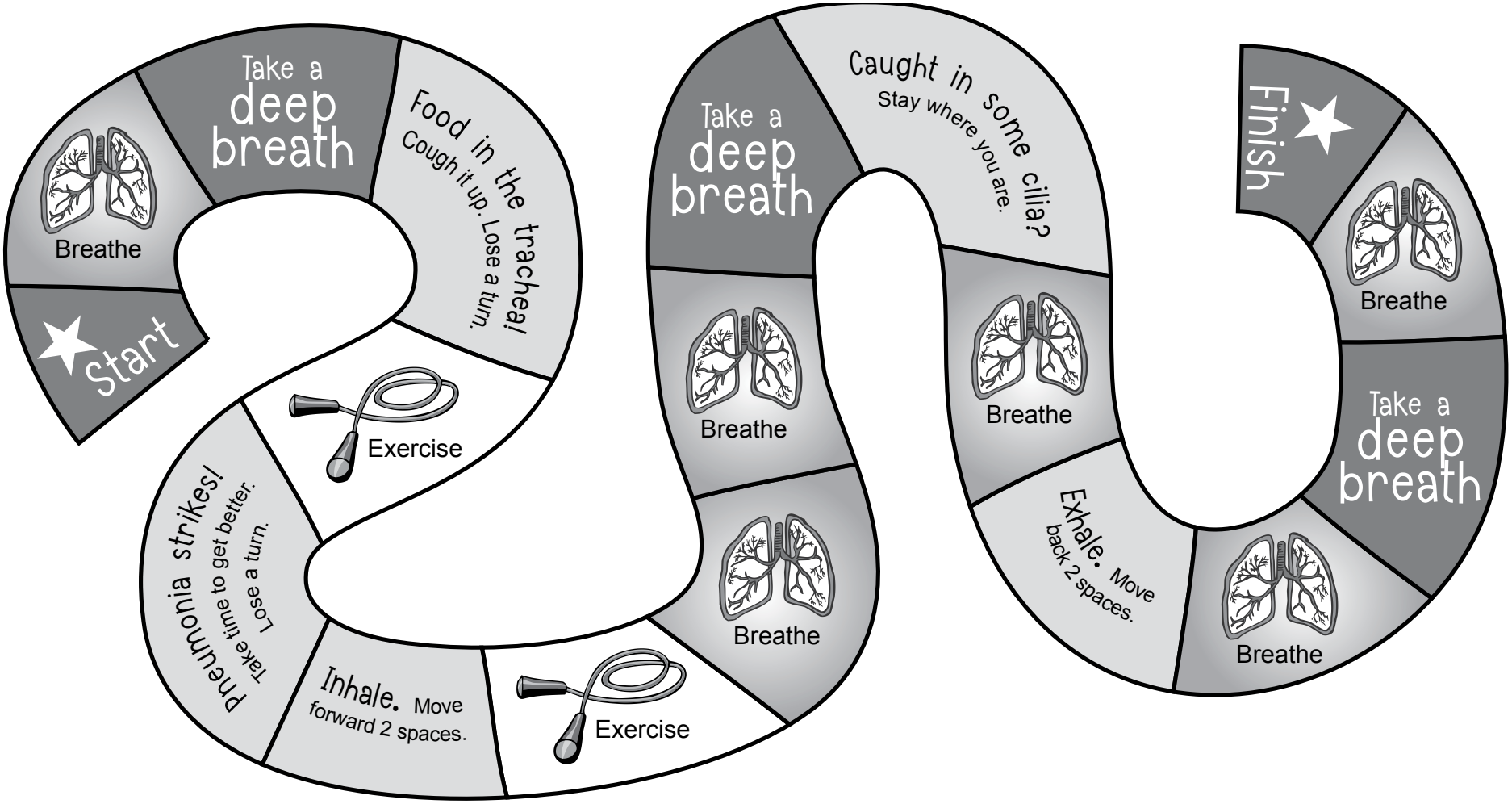
KidsHealth in the Classroom

Human Body Series

Respiratory System

Take a Breath! Game Board

Instructions: Roll the die and move that number of spaces, using a coin, paper clip, or other small item to mark your spot. Follow the directions on the game board. If you land on BREATHE: Pick a Breath Card. A correct answer moves you forward 1 space. If you land on TAKE A DEEP BREATH: Pick a Breath Card. A correct answer moves you forward 2 spaces. If you land on EXERCISE, good for you! You get to roll again! If you land on or roll past FINISH, you must answer a Breath Card correctly to win the game.



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